

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 7 6 2

♥ 8

♦ 6 5 2

♣ 7 5 4 3 2

♠ K Q 9 4

♥ A J 9 7 3

♦ 8 3

♣ A 6



♠ A 8 3

♥ 6 5 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4

♣ J 10

♠ 10 5

♥ K Q 10 4

♦ A K 7

♣ K Q 9 8

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♦

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♣

Pass

4♦

Pass

6♥

All Pass

6♥ by South

You continue the search for slam by showing your first round ♦ control, you bid 4♦.

That was all partner needed to hear, he jumps straight to 6♥.

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Just hold it a minute and DO NOT say 2♥. True, when partner transfers, you **almost** always just obey and complete the transfer. This is the one time when you don't. You had a 17 point 1NT opener with 4♥s and a doubleton. As soon as partner told you to bid ♥s your hand became worth 18 points because of the good trump support and the doubleton. So you inform partner of this by making the "super-accept" bid of 3♥. In other words, you complete the transfer with a jump.

Partner's eyes get big (but you aren't allowed to notice that) and he bids 4♣.

Partner's ♣ bid was not a suit, you already have an agreed suit, ♥s. The ♣ bid was showing you first round control in ♣s, and is a slam try by partner.

**Board 3**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 6 2  
 ♥ Q 10 5 3  
 ♦ Q J 5 3  
 ♣ 10 6 4

♠ Q 9 8 5 3

♥ 7 2

♦ 8 6 4 2

♣ A 3



♠ A K 7  
 ♥ J 9 8 6 4  
 ♦ 10  
 ♣ J 7 5 2

♠ J 10 4

♥ A K

♦ A K 9 7

♣ K Q 9 8

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 2NT   |
| Pass        | 3♥    | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass        | 3NT   | Pass | 4♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 4♠ by South |       |      |       |

You open 2NT and partner responds 3♥.

You bid 3♠, just as partner asked. He puts you in game at 3NT. Bid or pass?

Bid of course. You have an 8-card ♠ fit so you prefer ♠s to notrump.

As you can see, 3NT would surely go down with a ♥ lead, while 4♠ is cold.

One hand doesn't mean it will always be like this, but usually if you have an 8-card fit the Major suit game will be better than 3NT.

**Board 5**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 5 4 2

♥ 9 6 4

♦ Q 8 3

♣ A 9 5

♠ K 6

♥ A Q J 10 7

♦ 10 9 5

♣ K Q 3



♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 2

♦ J 7 6 4 2

♣ 10 7 2

♠ A J 10

♥ K 8 5 3

♦ A K

♣ J 8 6 4

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass        | 2♦    | Pass | 2♥    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 6♥    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by South |       |      |       |

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You are very close to being strong enough for a "Super-accept", but with this hand you should just complete the transfer to 2♥.

Partner now says 4NT.

If you don't remember Deal 9 go back and look at it now. Partner is not bidding Blackwood, he has about 16 points and is inviting you to bid a slam if you have a maximum. He is also telling you that he has just 5♥s and wants you to decide between the suit contract and notrump.

Once you understand partner's bid, your next move is simple. You have a maximum and you prefer to play in the suit. So you bid 6♥.